How Well Does the Evidence Support the Claims?

A reporting-quality review of the GPT-5.6 System Card (sections 3.1.2, 7.1, 7.2 and 7.4)

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1. Executive summary

This review examines how well four sections of OpenAI's GPT-5.6 System Card (3.1.2, 7.1, 7.2, 7.4) report the evidence behind their conclusions. It covers 11 evaluations and 5 headline claims, applying 11 pre-specified reporting criteria plus one judgment criterion. It does not assess whether the model is safe, and it could not verify any reported number.

The card does several things well. Figures 1 and 5 show the number of positive cases behind every rate, the authors state the lack of multiple-comparison correction twice, and simulation fidelity is measured against a noise funnel. I could reproduce the three flagged points in Fig. 6 and the median fidelity error of 1.5x from counts in Fig. 5.

The main gaps concern five areas:

- Uncertainty and sample size: no evaluation states the number of runs, and none fully states sample size (4 partly, 7 not reported). Uncertainty is fully reported for 4 of 10 applicable evaluations.
- Automated graders: 10 of 11 evaluations use an LLM judge or monitor; agreement with human labels is not shown for any of the 8 where the criterion applies (1 partly).
- Decision thresholds: "meets our safety bar", "not particularly high-risk" and "absolute rates remain low" are not tied to a stated criterion (0 of 10 applicable evaluations justify a threshold; 2 partly).
- Multiple comparisons: with 11 uncorrected tests at 0.1, two or more flags occur by chance about 30% of the time, and exactly two are flagged in Fig. 1.
- Wording versus figures: "slightly higher" metagaming for Sol appears alongside differences of 14-15 percentage points on two suites in Fig. 19.

Overall, the card is open about its limits, but for most headline results a reader cannot tell from the public text whether the reported differences are distinguishable from noise. In 8 of 11 evaluations the conclusion follows only partly from the data shown, in 2 it cannot be judged, and in 1 it follows.

2. Scope and method

2.1 Document reviewed

Item	Value
Title	GPT-5.6 System Card
Publisher	OpenAI, Deployment Safety Hub
URL	https://deploymentsafety.openai.com/gpt-5-6
Published	9 July 2026
Changes seen	3 August 2026 (prompt-injection results added); 19 August 2026 (one result corrected)
Accessed	19 October 2026 (HTML and PDF)
In scope	Sections 3.1.2, 7.1, 7.2, 7.4
Out of scope	All other sections, including capability evaluations (biology, cyber), safeguards, and the prompt-injection results

2.2 Criteria and rating

Each evaluation was rated against eleven checklist criteria (Appendix A) on a four-point scale: Reported, Partly, Not reported, Not applicable. One further criterion, whether the authors' conclusion follows from the data shown, is a judgment (Yes / Partly / No / Can't tell) and was recorded with a written reason. Criteria were fixed before detailed reading. No composite score is computed; the review reports counts per criterion only.

2.3 Process

1. Read the introduction and listed the headline claims in paraphrase.
2. Identified each evaluation in scope and recorded what it measures, its sample, runs, grader and baseline.
3. Rated the checklist criteria and the judgment criterion.
4. Recorded findings, separating observed fact from interpretation, with a pointer to the section or figure.
5. Planned: re-rate a sample after a delay and, if possible, by a second reviewer.

2.4 Independence and limits

The author has no financial or personal ties to the developer of the system reviewed, did not take part in its design, training or testing, and did not contribute to the document. The review is based only on the public document, without access to underlying data, grader outputs or code. Figures were read from image captures of the PDF. Some sample sizes were derived by dividing the positives shown by the rates shown in Figs. 1 and 5 and are marked "derived". "Not reported" means not visible to the reviewer in the document, not that the work was not done.

3. Claims inventory

ID	Section	Claim (paraphrased)	Decision it supports	Evidence	Support
C-01	7.1	In ChatGPT simulation, Sol shows about 10%	Increases in some categories are not	E-01, E-02, E-03	Partly

		less concealed uncertainty and about 30% less misrepresentation of work completion than GPT-5.5	considered particularly high-risk (overall rate of fabricated facts very low; judge for this category has lower precision); no novel classes of misaligned behaviour found		
C-02	7.2	In agentic coding, GPT-5.6 Sol more often takes severe (level 3) unrequested actions than GPT-5.5, but absolute rates remain low	Users should supervise the agent, especially on long trajectories; mitigation is a priority for future models	E-04, E-05	Partly
C-03	7.4	Verbalized metagaming is very low in deployment simulation, which adds confidence in that method, but higher in some evaluations and slightly higher for Sol than GPT-5.5 at matched effort	Evaluations with verbalized metagaming can be treated like contaminated evals; evaluating with deployment simulation adds confidence in this methodology	E-06, E-07, E-08	Partly
C-04	3.1.2	In ChatGPT deployment simulation, GPT-5.6 Sol is predicted to produce about the same amount of disallowed content as GPT-5.5; the only significant changes are sexual content (+40%, 0.05% to 0.07%) and disallowed mental-health responses (about -40%, 0.03% to 0.02%)	Absolute rates remain low and the model "meets our safety bar"; result does not materially change the overall risk profile	E-09, E-10	Partly
C-05	7.4.2	Verbalized metagaming in training varies a lot between datasets and steps, trends slightly upward in aggregate, and has rates	No decision stated; described as an area for further research	E-11	Partly

		comparable to evaluations, which the authors read as metagaming being more general than evaluation awareness			

Notes on each claim are in the claims table of the audit workbook (claims.csv in the repository).

4. Findings

Each finding has an observation, a pointer, a classification as fact or interpretation, a consequence for interpretation (indicative), and a question that would resolve it. Strengths come first.

4.1 Strengths

S-1

Figs. 1 and 5 show rates per 100k together with the number of positives for every category and for production, GPT-5.5 simulation and Sol simulation, so readers can see the counts behind each ratio.

Pointer: 3.1.2, Fig. 1; 7.1, Fig. 5 | Fact | Consequence: Positive

Question to authors: Could the same counts be shown in Fig. 7?

S-2

Limitations are stated plainly: no multiple-comparison correction (stated twice), lower judge precision for one category, earlier estimates not validated, some fidelity errors not consistent with noise, the metagaming judgement is non-causal, and internal-traffic results are a signal about internal rather than external deployment.

Pointer: 3.1.2, 7.1, 7.2, 7.4 | Fact | Consequence: Positive

Question to authors: Could these limits be gathered in one place for each section?

S-3

Simulation fidelity is measured and plotted against a noise funnel, with the formula in a footnote. From counts in Fig. 5 I reproduced the three points flagged in Fig. 6 (effective counts about 283, 8.2 and 5.6) and the median fidelity error of 1.5x.

Pointer: 3.1.2 footnote 1; 7.1, Figs. 5-6 | Fact | Consequence: Positive

Question to authors: Could the per-category fidelity table be published?

4.2 Gaps and open questions

Finding ID (Type)

Observation (what the document does or does not show)

Pointer: Pointer (section / figure) | Fact or interpretation | Consequence: Consequence for interpretation

Question to authors: Question to the authors / what would resolve it

G-1 (Gap)

Significance flags use a two-sided Fisher test at 0.1 with no correction (stated). With 9 categories in Fig. 5, about 0.9 false flags are expected even if nothing changed, and two or more occur by chance about 22% of the time; two are flagged (concealed uncertainty, misrepresenting work completion). With 11 categories in Fig. 1, two or more flags occur by chance about 30% of the time, and exactly two are flagged (sexual content up, mental health down).

Pointer: 7.1, Fig. 5; 3.1.2 | Both | Consequence: Medium (indicative)

Question to authors: Report adjusted results or a false-discovery rate, and state the number of categories tested.

G-2 (Gap)

The headline 10% reduction in concealed uncertainty (predicted change 1.1x) is smaller than the fidelity error measured for the same category (1.2x, flagged outside noise). For sexual content (3.1.2) the predicted +40% (1.4x) is similar in size to its flagged fidelity error (1.3x). In Fig. 6, 3 of 9 categories are flagged (about 33% vs about 10% expected; 3 or more by chance about 5%), against 1 of 11 in Figs. 1-2.

Pointer: 7.1, Figs. 5-6; 3.1.2, Fig. 2 | Both | Consequence: Medium (indicative)

Question to authors: Does comparing two simulations cancel the fidelity error for this category? Can a paired analysis show it?

G-3 (Gap)

Several predicted changes rest on very few positives: Background Task up 3.6x (1 vs 3), Confirmation Hacking up 2.4x (1 vs 2), Calculator Hack to zero from a handful of cases. Ratios are shown without intervals.

Pointer: 7.1, Fig. 5 | Fact | Consequence: Medium (indicative)

Question to authors: Show intervals for ratios, or suppress ratios below a minimum count.

G-4 (Unclear)

Counts divided by rates imply about 437k production turns, about 290k simulated GPT-5.5 turns and about 240k simulated Sol turns in 7.1 (derived; consistent across categories), although both simulations resample the same prefixes. In 3.1.2 the two simulations are nearly equal (about 202k vs 209k). The Fisher test treats the two simulations as independent, not paired.

Pointer: 7.1, Fig. 5 | Both | Consequence: Low (indicative)

Question to authors: Why do the simulated turn counts differ, and does this affect the rates?

G-5 (Gap)

Risk judgements are not tied to a stated criterion: “meets our safety bar” (3.1.2), “not particularly high-risk” (7.1), “absolute rates remain low” (7.2). In Fig. 5 the increases the text refers to carry no significance marker, which the text does not give as a reason.

Pointer: 3.1.2; 7.1; 7.2 | Both | Consequence: High (indicative)

Question to authors: What result would have changed the release decision or required mitigation, and where was that fixed in advance?

G-6 (Gap)

Fig. 7 (no caption): Sol shows 0.251% of resampled traffic with severity-3 circumventing restrictions vs 0.026% for GPT-5.5 (about 10x; error bars do not overlap). The unit of analysis, counts and the meaning of the bars are not stated, and “low” is not defined. A per-turn rate compounds over long trajectories, the use the authors warn about (my interpretation).

Pointer: 7.2, Fig. 7 | Both | Consequence: Medium (indicative)

Question to authors: What is the unit (turn, trajectory), how many items, and what rate would not be “low”?

G-7 (Gap)

7.4 says Sol shows more metagaming than GPT-5.5 and 7.4.1 says “slightly higher”, while Fig. 19 shows +15 points on Instruction following (33.1% vs 18.2%) and +14 on Honesty (55.4% vs 41.2%), and about 2-3.5x relative differences on the two low-rate suites. Sol’s Instruction following rate is 23.8% in Fig. 17 but 33.1% in Fig. 19; the reasoning-effort setting behind this is not stated.

Pointer: 7.4, 7.4.1, Figs. 17, 19 | Both | Consequence: Medium (indicative)

Question to authors: Which reasoning efforts were used in each figure, and is “slightly” the authors’ intended description?

G-8 (Gap)

No accuracy or agreement figures are given for the judges and monitors in 3.1.2, 7.1, 7.2 or 7.4 (lower precision is admitted for one category). Fig. 17 applies a cutoff of 70 to the 0-100 validity rating; the text defines the rating but not the cutoff, and 22.7% of Honesty-suite samples exceed it.

Pointer: 3.1.2, 7.1, 7.2, 7.4.1 Fig. 17 | Fact | Consequence: Medium (indicative)

Question to authors: What is each monitor’s agreement with human labels on a held-out sample, and how was the cutoff of 70 chosen?

G-9 (Gap)

Visual conventions are not defined in captions: filled vs open markers (Figs. 2, 6), asterisks (Figs. 1, 5, 18), the meaning of error bars (Figs. 1, 5, 7, 17-19), the colour coding of the pills in Fig. 1 and the test behind the colours in Fig. 20; Fig. 7 has no caption.

Pointer: Figs. 1, 2, 5-7, 17-20 | Fact | Consequence: Low (indicative)

Question to authors: Add legends and captions defining markers, bars and tests.

U-1 (Unclear)

Verbalized metagaming is very low in deployment simulation (0.05% ChatGPT, 0.15% Codex, Fig. 17), which the authors say adds confidence in the method. Real traffic does not look like a test, so a low rate may reflect the input distribution as much as the method, and only verbalized reasoning is measured.

Pointer: 7.4, Fig. 17 | Interpretation | Consequence: Medium (indicative)

Question to authors: Is there evidence of methodological advantage beyond the difference in input type?

U-2 (Unclear)

Training metagaming (Fig. 20): about nine datasets, aggregate moves from about 0.17 to about 0.20 with no interval, and one dataset rises from about 3% to about 36%. Dataset sizes and the test behind the colours are not shown, so “slightly upward” and “comparable rates” cannot be checked.

Pointer: 7.4.2, Fig. 20 | Both | Consequence: Low (indicative)

Question to authors: Provide intervals and dataset sizes for Fig. 20.

G-10 (Gap)

For sexual content (3.1.2, Fig. 1) the GPT-5.5 simulation gives 49.9 per 100k against 63.8 in production (1.28x too low), while the Sol simulation gives 71.7. The predicted +40% compares Sol with this low simulated baseline; relative to production the Sol figure is +12%. The text does not discuss whether simulation bias is the same for both models.

Pointer: 3.1.2, Fig. 1 | Interpretation | Consequence: Medium (indicative)

Question to authors: Is the simulation bias assumed identical across models, and how sensitive is the +40% to that assumption?

5. Cross-cutting observations

Of the 11 evaluations reviewed, none fully reports sample size (4 partly, 7 not reported; in several cases the count can only be derived from figures) and none reports the number of runs. Uncertainty is reported in full for 4 of 10 applicable evaluations and partly for 5 more, but the meaning of error bars and markers is often not defined in captions (G-9).

Graders are LLM-based in 10 of 11 evaluations; for the remaining one (E-02) the grader is not stated. The grader is described in full for 5 of 10 applicable evaluations. Validation against human labels is reported for none of the 8 applicable evaluations and partly for one. Thresholds that drive a decision are justified in none of 10 applicable cases.

On the positive side, baselines (8 of 10 fully, 2 partly) and comparability caveats (8 of 9 fully) are well covered, and the authors note that some prior estimates could not be validated. Reproduction materials are partly available for 5 of 11 evaluations and absent for 6.

Criterion	Reported	Partly	Not reported	N/A
C1 Sample size	0	4	7	0
C2 Runs	0	0	11	0
C3 Uncertainty	4	5	1	1
C4 Baseline	8	2	0	1
C5 Comparability caveats	8	1	0	2
C6 Metric and scoring rule	6	4	1	0
C7 Grader described	5	4	1	1
C8 Grader validated	0	1	7	3
C9 Elicitation	0	6	0	5
C10 Threshold justified	0	2	8	1
C11 Reproduction materials	0	5	6	0

Judgment criterion J1 (conclusion follows from data): Yes 1, Partly 8, No 0, Can't tell 2.

6. Recommendations

For readers of the card

- Treat small differences between models as uncertain unless intervals, repeat runs or paired analyses are shown (G-1, G-2, G-3).
- Read relative changes together with absolute rates and counts; a 3.6x rise may rest on one case versus three (G-3, G-10).
- Check which figure and which reasoning-effort setting a quoted number comes from (G-7).
- Prefer conclusions stated together with their stated limitations.

For authors of system cards

- Report an uncertainty measure and the number of positive cases beside every headline rate, including Fig. 7 (G-3, G-6).
- State the number of categories tested and provide adjusted results or a false-discovery rate (G-1).
- Publish agreement with human labels for each automated judge and justify cutoffs such as 70 in Fig. 17 (G-8).
- Link phrases such as "safety bar" and "low" to a pre-stated criterion (G-5).

- Define markers, asterisks and error bars in captions (G-9).

7. Limitations and next steps

- Public document only; no access to data, code or grader outputs.
- Figures were read from image captures; derived sample sizes are approximations.
- One reviewer; ratings are my judgment. A second independent rating of a sample is planned.
- Findings carry indicative consequence ratings, not calibrated ones.
- Next: apply the same workbook to a second lab's card to compare reporting practice; replicate small-scale versions of selected evaluations on an open model.

8. Disclaimer

This is an independent, educational review of a public document. It does not assess the real-world safety of any model, does not allege misconduct or bad faith by anyone, does not constitute legal advice, and does not claim compliance or non-compliance with any regulation. Statements marked "interpretation" are the reviewer's opinion. The author is not affiliated with OpenAI. Corrections and comments are welcome: [contact].

Appendix A. Criteria

ID	Criterion	Rated "Reported" when	Validation area (analogy)
ID	Criterion	What counts as 'Reported'	Validation area (analogy)
C1	Sample size stated	Number of items/cases/tasks is given for the evaluation	Outcomes analysis
C2	Number of runs / seeds stated	How many repeated runs or rollouts underlie each number	Outcomes analysis
C3	Uncertainty reported	Confidence interval, error bar or explicit noise estimate	Outcomes analysis
C4	Baseline or comparison provided	Previous model, human baseline or simple method for context	Outcomes analysis
C5	Comparability caveats stated	Notes if graders, policies, datasets or versions changed between compared results	Process and implementation
C6	Metric and scoring rule defined	Precise definition, including special rules (e.g. how refusals or partial credit are scored)	Conceptual soundness
C7	Grader described	Says who or what grades (human, programmatic, LLM judge) and with what instructions	Conceptual soundness
C8	Grader validated	Agreement or accuracy against human labels, or other evidence the grader works	Conceptual soundness

C9	Elicitation described	Prompting, scaffolding, reasoning effort; whether result is a lower bound on capability	Process and implementation
C10	Threshold or decision rule justified	If the evaluation drives a decision, the threshold and its rationale are stated	Conceptual soundness
C11	Materials for reproduction available	Data, code or enough detail to rerun (or a statement why not)	Process and implementation
J1	Conclusion matches evidence (judgment)	Rated on the Evaluations sheet, column 'Follows from data?'	Outcomes analysis

The "validation area" column is an analogy to model-risk-management practice, not a regulatory requirement.

Appendix B. Evaluation summary

ID	Sect.	Evaluation	n	Runs	Uncert.	Grader	Follows?
E-01	7.1	Simulation-based forecasts, concealed uncertainty and misrepresentation of work	Derived from Fig. 5 (positives / rate): about 437k production turns, a	Not stated	Yes	LLM judge	Partly
E-02	7.1	Audit for new misalignment classes found	Not stated	Not stated	N/A	Not stated	Can't tell
E-03	7.1	Simulation fidelity check	9 categories; effective positive counts from about 0.8 to about 283 (F	Not stated	Yes	LLM judge	Yes
E-04	7.2	Deployment simulation, internal agentic coding traffic	Not shown (no counts in Fig. 7; unit of analysis not defined)	Not stated	Partly	LLM judge	Partly
E-05	7.2	Simulator realism check (head-to-head)	Not stated	Not stated	No	LLM judge	Can't tell
E-06	7.4.1	Measuring Metagaming in evaluations	Not shown; unit is “monitored samples” (Fig. 17)	Not stated	Partly	LLM judge	Partly
E-07	7.4.1	Measuring Alignment evaluation metagaming over training	Not shown (Fig. 18)	Not stated	Partly	LLM judge	Partly
E-08	7.4.1	Comparing the Metagaming rate	Not shown (Fig. 19)	Not stated	Partly	LLM judge	Partly

		for GPT-5.6 Sol vs. GPT-5.5					
E-09	3.1.2	Simulation-based forecast of disallowed-content changes (ChatGPT traffic), Sol vs GPT-5.5	Derived from Fig. 1 (positives / rate): about 405k production turns, a	Not stated	Yes	LLM judge	Partly
E-10	3.1.2	Simulation quality check (noise funnel), disallowed-content categories	11 categories; effective counts from about 0.9 to about 73 (Fig. 2; re	Not stated	Yes	LLM judge	Partly
E-11	7.4.2	Metagaming in training	About 9 datasets (subsampled); sizes not shown (Fig. 20)	Not stated (averaged	Partly	LLM judge	Partly

Source: audit workbook, sheet Evaluations (evaluations.csv).

Appendix C. Version log of this review

Version	Date	Change
v0.1	Oct 2026	Template
v0.2	5 Nov 2026	Populated from workbook v3